14 Must-Have Preps to Survive 90 Days Without Power EP 341

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📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter outlines 14 tangible preps for a 90-day power outage (cash, water, food, comms, sanitation, firearms) then argues discipline is a myth — managed dopamine, peer environment, vision boards, and pain/pleasure rewiring manufacture motivation instead.

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🌍 Context & Why You Should Prep Now 7:46

- Governments worldwide are telling citizens to prepare for disaster
  - Cited threats: El Niño–related natural disasters, widespread AI/website hacks, potential conflict with Iran (Tucker Carlson reportedly claimed Trump has a plan to bomb Iran)
  - The Pentagon has told military bases to prepare to be **self-sufficient for 90 days**
  - DC experienced a power outage the day before this episode was recorded
  - Gary, Indiana recently lost power for weeks — no hack, no bomb, just infrastructure failure
  - Queens, NY had an 8-day blackout in July 2006 due to extreme heat and equipment failure
- Brandon's thesis: even if no geopolitical disaster occurs, natural disasters (hurricanes, tornadoes, earthquakes, mudslides) make preparedness universally necessary
- He has been a prepper for over a decade; had supplies ready when Hurricane Sandy hit New York

💵 Prep 1: Cash on Hand & Important Documents 9:49

- If the grid goes down, all digital payment systems fail: credit cards, debit cards, Apple Pay, Zelle, Venmo — none will work
- Recommendation: withdraw **a few thousand dollars** from the bank as soon as possible
- Gather all critical documents:
  - Government-issued IDs
  - Insurance paperwork
  - Lease agreement
  - Written list of all medications and dosages needed to stay alive
- Called the easiest prep to execute immediately

📻 Prep 2: Weather Radio 11:33

- Your phone will likely be dead; a weather radio may be your only source of real-time information
- Use cases: current weather, open/closed roads, latest emergency news
- Available at Amazon, Home Depot, or Lowe's — described as "super cheap"
- Get one that runs on **batteries or USB** for maximum flexibility
- **Practice using it before you need it** — don't try to figure it out during an emergency

🛰️ Prep 3: Satellite Internet (Starlink) 12:50

- Recommended product: **Starlink** (Brandon notes he is not a fan of Elon Musk but calls it the best option)
- Key advantage: satellites operate in space and are unaffected by regional ground-level outages
- Past outages have been regional, not nationwide — satellite internet may still function
- Brandon's personal plan: use Starlink + solar-charged power banks to continue streaming/vlogging during a grid-down event

📚 Prep 4: Offline Digital Library 14:23

- Download a version of Wikipedia directly to your device — no internet required
- Free app: **Kiwix** (K-I-W-I-X) — saves Wikipedia to phone, tablet, computer, or USB stick
- Not the full version of Wikipedia, but far better than nothing
- Use case: looking up how to fix things, manage sanitation, or solve problems without connectivity

🤖 Prep 5: Local AI on Your Devices 16:01

- If the grid is down in your area, cloud AI (ChatGPT, Claude) won't be accessible
- Solution: download and run a **local AI model** on your laptop, tablet, or phone
- Recommended software: **LM Studio** (Brandon's preference over Llama)
  - Allows you to download small local models (e.g., Gemini's compact models) that run offline
  - Runs slowly unless you have high-end hardware, but functional
  - Also available on phone
  - On iPhone: LM Studio can interface with Apple's on-device AI model (already built into the phone) like a ChatGPT interface — no internet needed
- Alternative: **Llama** (mentioned but Brandon prefers LM Studio)

🧴 Prep 6: Hygiene Supplies 18:05

- Without power (especially in hot climates like Miami), personal hygiene degrades fast — no AC, heavy sweating
- Stock up on:
  - **Hand sanitizer** — conserves water vs. handwashing
  - **Hygiene/body wipes** — substitute for showering
  - **Mouthwash** and extra toothbrushes/toothpaste
- Brush teeth with a small amount of stored water to stay functional around family
- Acknowledge reality: "y'all gonna be stinking 100%" — manage it, don't ignore it

🚽 Prep 7: Sanitation / Bucket System 20:14

- If you live in a house: use the yard or nearby woods — simplest solution
- If you live in a high-rise (Brandon's situation in a Miami skyscraper): toilets won't flush without water pressure
- **The Bucket System** — step by step:
  - Get a 5-gallon bucket
  - Line it with garbage bags
  - Add **kitty litter** to the bottom
  - Install a **bucket toilet seat/lid** on top

    - After each use, add more kitty litter on top
    - Store the bucket on a balcony
- Brandon jokes about his fiber-heavy keto diet (~2–3 bowel movements/day) making this a frequent necessity

💡 Prep 8: Lighting 23:04

- Candles are explicitly discouraged — fire risk when fire department may be unavailable
- Recommended instead:
    - **Headlamps** — keep hands free
    - **Solar-powered lanterns** — charge on balcony/outside during the day, provide light all night
- Stock extra batteries for battery-powered devices
- Brandon's setup: multiple solar lanterns charged daily on his wraparound condo balcony

🩹 Prep 9: First Aid & Medications 24:17

- Purchase a **first aid kit** from Amazon — search "first aid kit"
- Critical: stock **90 days' worth of any prescription medications** you cannot skip
    - Examples: blood pressure medication, insulin, other life-sustaining drugs
    - Brandon humorously notes he has 90 days of his own supplements (peptides, testosterone) even though they aren't strictly survival-critical

🔋 Prep 10: Power Banks & Solar Panels 25:30

- Brandon's setup: multiple large **power banks** paired with **solar panels**
- His condo wraps around the building — sun hits from sunrise to sunset, enabling all-day charging
- Goal: stay powered to run Starlink, stream, and charge devices through the entire outage
- Recommendation: get **more than one** of each (see Rule: "two is one, one is none")

🍳 Prep 11: Off-Grid Cooking (Situational) 27:25

- **Only for those living in a house with outdoor space**
- Do NOT use camp stoves or propane indoors in condos/apartments — **carbon monoxide risk**
- Brandon's personal strategy: skip off-grid cooking entirely; rely only on canned goods that can be eaten raw/cold
- If you have a yard: prep an outdoor cooking setup (grill, camp stove) before you need it

❄️ Prep 12: Cooling (Climate-Dependent) 28:33

- Critical for anyone living **below the Mason-Dixon Line** or in tropical climates
- Miami example: 80°F outside even in fall, unbearable without AC

- Brandon's solution: ordered multiple **battery/solar-powered fans** ahead of time
- He already had these stocked from prior prepping (had everything ready before Hurricane Sandy in NY)

🥫 Prep 13: Food & Calorie Stockpile 29:21

- Minimum target: **2,000 calories per day per person** in the household for 90 days
- Brandon's preferred foods (require no cooking, no water):
  - Canned sardines, canned salmon, canned tuna, canned chicken, other canned meats
  - Nuts, nut butters (almond butter, peanut butter)
  - Protein-focused to maintain muscle mass
- Common preps (rice, beans, oats, pasta) require water to cook — be cautious since water is precious
- **Critical consumption order:**
  - Step 1 — Eat everything in the refrigerator first (perishable, will spoil)
  - Step 2 — Eat everything in the freezer next
  - Step 3 — Only then dip into your dry/canned stash
- Do NOT start eating your stash the moment power goes out

💧 Prep 14: Water Storage & Purification 31:44

- Recommended minimum: **1 gallon of water per day per person**
- Brandon's strategy (instead of pre-buying bulk water):
  - Buy ~20 large water storage containers now
  - The moment power goes out, immediately fill every container from the tap (buildings may still have residual pressure or backup generators)
  - Fill bathtubs too — every container that can hold water
- Also purchase a **water purification/filtration system**
  - Especially important for tub water or natural sources (streams, lakes)
  - Example: near Lake Michigan in Chicago = fresh water accessible with the right filter
  - Cannot drink salt water (Atlantic Ocean)
- Prioritize getting the filtration system **before** an emergency — too late once it hits

🔫 Bonus Prep: Firearms for Self-Defense 34:59

- Brandon's reasoning: when he was younger, his plan would have been to rob preppers — he assumes others think the same
- Even good people become dangerous when survival instincts kick in and they see their children starving
- By day 70+ of a grid-down scenario, neighborhoods (especially houses) may resemble "the Purge" after dark with no street lights
- High-rise advantages: single elevator entry point, multiple locked doors, criminals must climb many stairs

- Houses have multiple entry points — higher vulnerability, stronger case for firearms
- Recommendations:
  - **Stock up on firearms**
  - **Learn to shoot now** — visit the range, practice aim before you need it
  - Build **endurance** — "fatigue makes cowards of us all"

📋 5 Survival Rules to Implement Now 38:41

- **Rule 1 — Buy in stages:** You are running out of time; make incremental purchases now; add prep items to each week's grocery run
- **Rule 2 — Set aside current stock:** Any canned goods already in your pantry — stop eating them, designate them as reserve
- **Rule 3 — Get systems ready before the event:**
  - You cannot store 90 days of fuel or fill water containers after the fact
  - Get your water filter, batteries, and solar equipment set up and tested now
  - Keep all devices and power banks charged at all times
- **Rule 4 — "Two is one, one is none":**
  - Every critical system needs a backup
  - Backup power station, backup fans, backup lighting — aim for more than enough
  - Test both primary and backup systems before you need them
  - Run family drills: "Power's out — go fill every container with water NOW"
- **Rule 5 — Get physically ready:**
  - If you have stairs in your living situation, start walking them regularly
  - Hit the shooting range; learn your firearm
  - Build cardiovascular endurance — fatigue undermines decision-making and courage

🧠 Discipline Is a Myth — The Dopamine Framework 52:54

- Brandon's core thesis: **discipline is amateur hour** — what high performers have is not discipline but rewired motivation
- Key story: David Goggins (from *Can't Hurt Me*) spontaneously ran a marathon in street clothes with injured legs — he *wanted* to do it; it would have taken discipline *not* to
  - True discipline = doing what you're supposed to do when you don't feel like it
  - Goggins wasn't even supposed to run — he did it for love of the pursuit
- Goal: restructure your brain so you *want* to do the things that accomplish your goals — then you need discipline only to *stop*, not to start
- **The Dopamine Science:**
  - Dopamine is NOT the reward chemical — it is the **chemical of pursuit / motivation**
  - Books recommended:

    - *Dopamine Nation*
    - *The Molecule of More*
  - Think of dopamine as a reservoir in your brain
  - Activities that spike dopamine fast and high **drain the reservoir**: recreational drugs, casual sex, pornography, video games, endless scrolling, nightlife, binge TV
  - Drained reservoir = low motivation / low drive
  - This is why chronic porn users do NoFap and suddenly feel like they have "superpowers" — they just refilled their normal dopamine reserves
  - Same effect applies to weed, alcohol, cocaine, nightclubs
- **Contrast effect:** going from a dopamine-spiking night (clubs, drugs, casual sex) to mundane work (accounting, your job) makes the work feel far worse than it actually is
  - Analogy: waking from a dream where his deceased father was alive makes Brandon's objectively great real life feel momentarily worse by contrast
- **Activities that increase dopamine WITHOUT depleting the reservoir:**

Activity	Notes
Cold exposure (ice bath, cold shower, cryotherapy)	Doubles dopamine; no crash; lasts hours
Exercise	Increases circulating dopamine
L-Tyrosine (amino acid supplement)	Proven to increase dopamine
Caffeine	Increases dopamine without reservoir depletion

- Brandon quit recreational drugs and alcohol **10+ years ago** and credits this as a major factor in financial success
  - Stopped staying out late → started sleeping and waking earlier → more productive hours
  - Stopped making drunk/high mistakes

> "If you're motivated, you don't need discipline. Discipline is amateur hour."

👥 Rule 2: Change Who You Surround Yourself With 1:16:35

- Study finding: **your friends' income is the #1 predictor of your own success**
- You become like the people around you *involuntarily* — accent, political beliefs, religion, habits — all largely absorbed from environment, not chosen
- Harvard University study: if one spouse begins a weight-loss journey, the other spouse loses weight *without trying*
  - Works in reverse: men commonly gain weight when their wives are pregnant (involuntary habit mirroring)
- Obesity contagion study (long-term study):
  - If a friend gets fat → **40% chance you get fat**

    - If a *friend of a friend* (someone you don't even know) gets fat → **20% chance you get fat**
- Implication: actively encourage the success of your friends — both altruistic AND self-protective
    - Jay-Z quote (*Reasonable Doubt*, "Feeling It"): *"If every n---a in your clique is rich, your clique is rugged. No one will fall 'cause everyone will be each other's crutches."*
- Real example: Brandon spent months helping a friend fix Facebook/Instagram ads
    - Previous cost per webinar registrant: **$30**
    - After Brandon restructured ads, wrote copy, and coached the team: **$5 per registrant**
- Brandon's girlfriend now tracks calories and macros — involuntary adoption of his habits over the relationship

🎯 Rule 3: Create a Visible Goal / Vision Board 1:24:09

- Brandon had video editor "Fly with Johnny Tai" Photoshop him holding two awards he hadn't won yet:
    - YouTube Gold Play Button (1M subscribers)
    - ClickFunnels $10M funnel award
    - Printed it out and kept it on his desk in New York — visible every day
    - He subsequently won both awards
- In college: cut a photo of a **Roland Fantom keyboard (~$2,000)** from a music magazine, laminated it, carried it in his pocket all summer — his dad won gambling money and bought him the keyboard
- Science behind it — **Reticular Activating System (RAS):**
    - Located at the base of the brainstem
    - Filters the overwhelming flood of sensory input — narrows focus to what your brain deems important
    - Classic example: buy a new car model → suddenly see that car everywhere (the cars were always there; RAS just wasn't flagging them)
    - Vision board activates the RAS toward your goal → you start noticing opportunities and paths you previously overlooked
- Bill Buckner cautionary example (reticular activation working negatively):
    - Before the World Series, Buckner said on record: "The nightmare is you're going to let the winning run score on a ground ball through your legs."
    - That exact thing happened to him in the 1986 World Series
- Also create your vision board using **ChatGPT / AI image generation** — describe yourself outside your dream home, with specific cars, location, etc.; print and post on wall
- **The Quit Zone:**
    - Success is NOT linear — it's exponential with a long flat section at the start
    - In the gap between expected and actual progress, most people quit
    - Vision boards/visible goals help you stay focused on the destination during the quit zone
    - Once you push through, progress hockey-sticks and outcomes exceed expectations (the "baller zone")

😤 Rule 4: The List of Hate & the List of Great 1:46:26

- Based on Sigmund Freud's **Pleasure-Pain Principle**: all human behavior is either moving toward perceived pleasure or away from perceived pain
- If you associate pain with healthy eating/working out and pleasure with junk food/gaming, you'll need discipline constantly — an exhausting, losing battle
- Solution: **rewire the associations** using two lists
- **The List of Hate:**
  - Write down every person who doubted you, hated on you, said you couldn't do it
  - Every time you don't feel like doing the work, look at this list
  - Realize: if you don't do it, the haters win
  - Provides an *instant jolt of motivation* — converts avoidance into action
- **The List of Great:**
  - Vividly describe the highest version of yourself who has accomplished all your goals
  - What time does this person wake up? Do they track macros? Do they play video games all day? Do they chase validation?
  - Write down every attribute of this ideal self
- **How to use both lists daily:**
  - Every time you act in accordance with the "list of great," you get a natural dopamine spike (positive reinforcement)
  - Repeated exposure makes those behaviors addictive — you start *wanting* to do them
  - Pain/pleasure associations flip: healthy eating becomes pleasurable; junk food feels painful
  - End state: you don't need discipline to do the right things — you need discipline to *stop*
- Brandon's real-life example: weighs food at restaurants with a scale; a family member called it "so disciplined"; Brandon's internal thought: "It would take discipline for me to eat like you."
- Alex Hormozi quote: "Winners don't have something losers don't — they *lack* something losers don't. That thing is an off switch."
- Brandon's current reality: woke up, made pre-workout the night before, was at his desk working within 5 minutes of getting out of bed; his girlfriend had to tell him to stop at 3 AM

📅 Rule 5: Plan Every Hour of Every Day 1:58:32

- Bruce Lee quote: *"If you love life, don't waste time, because time is what life is made of."*
- Brandon calls hourly calendar planning his **#1 productivity hack of all time**
- Claim: implementing this will allow you to accomplish more in **60 days** than most people do in an entire year
- Brandon shows his own calendar on screen — every hour is blocked
- He references a separate video titled **"60 Days Left"** for a full breakdown of the system — recommends clicking that video for the complete how-to

- Carries both an iPhone and an Android device; uses calendar across both